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How to install the community FoF map thumbnails update (2025-02)

By [WL/S³] Weasel (Probably AFK)

★★★★★

Not enough ratings

Guide for downloading and installing the community-developed thumbnails update for Fistful of Frags (FoF).







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0 - Translations & Revision History Edit

Available Translations:

- Google Translate (a last resort): **Do NOT click the URL below. Copy and paste the text below into your browser! Just clicking the link will NOT work - due to how the Steam Community web-site mangles URLs.**

`https://translate.google.com/translate?js=n&sl=en&tl=auto&u=https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3443309293`

Revision History:

NOTE: Latest updates at the top.

Revision Date	Revision Notes
20250317	Added translation information.
20250315	Adjusting alignment of images.
20250313	Initial publication.
20250312	Initial creation, pre-publication.

1 - About this update Edit

The purpose of this update it to resolve some issues with the in-game server-list features of Fistful of Frags (FoF).

In particular, the preview thumbnails (images) used to show which map is currently in use on each of the servers shown in the **FoF** multi-player interface.

Currently, the last official update to thumbnail previews a almost **two (2)** years ago, and only included thumbnail previews for "official" maps. This results in many servers being shown with the generic "**Custom Map**" icon, instead of an actual preview thumbnail of the map they are currently running.

CREATED BY

 [WL/S³] Weasel (Probably AFK)
Last Online 16 hrs, 48 mins ago

Category: Co-op, Modding or Configuration, Multiplayer, Secrets

Languages: English

Posted Mar 12 @ 11:22pm

Updated Mar 17 @ 12:41pm

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AUTHOR STATS

7 Unique Visitors
(Public number)

1 Current Favorites
(Public number)

https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3443309293

1/9

In short, what this update does, is to accomplish this:



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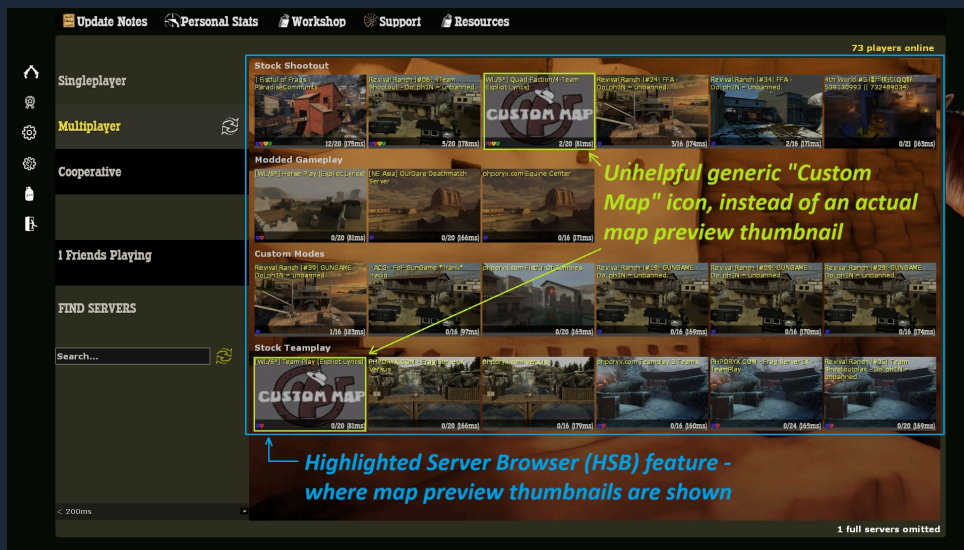
2 - Wait, which "server-list"?

Fistful of Frags (FoF) actually has two different lists of servers, which are related but not the same. This can cause some confusion, especially for new players.

These two server-list features are:

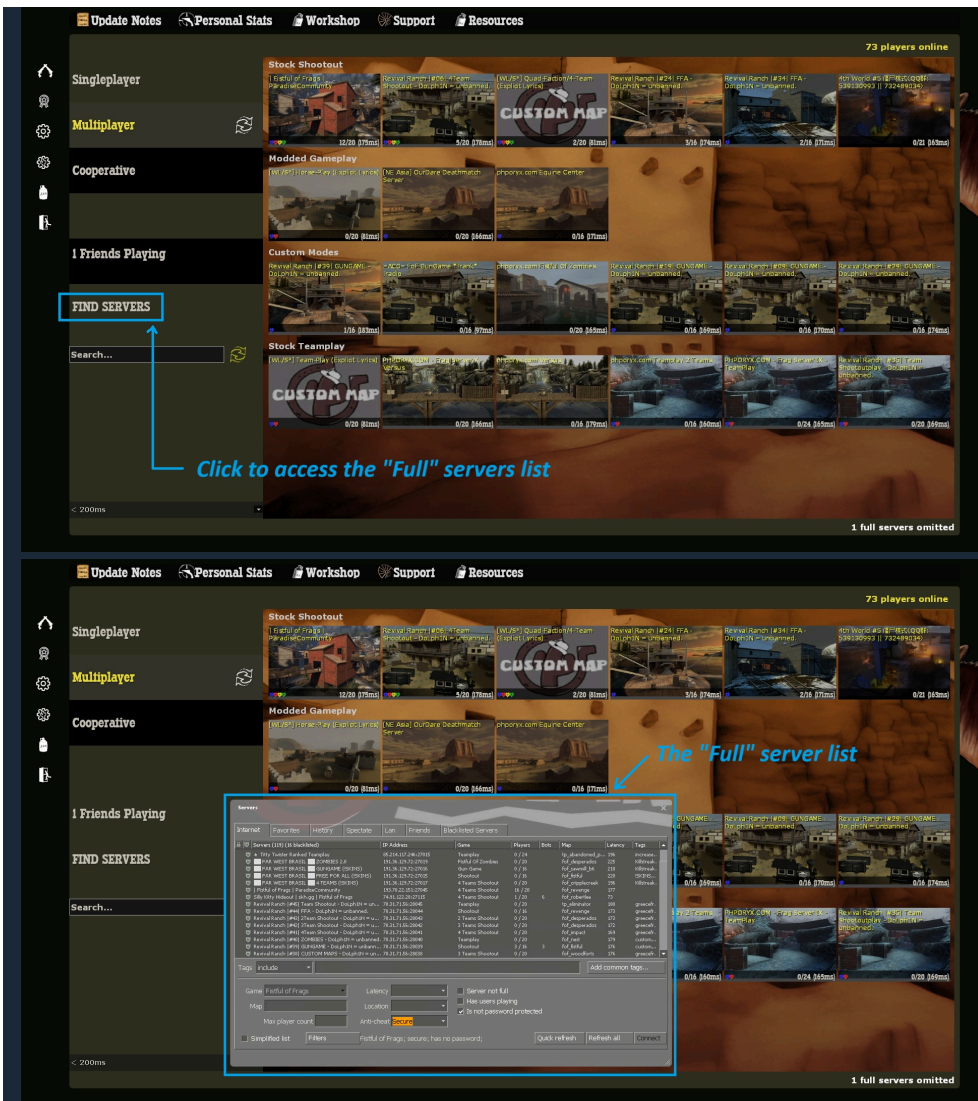
- The "Highlighted Server Browser" (or HSB). list.
- The "Full" server-list.

Highlighted Server Browser (or HSB):



- This is the screen you see when you first enter the game, showing thumbnail preview images of different maps running on available game-servers. Because of its visual nature (images), this is referred-to as the **Highlighted Server Browser** (or **HSB**).
- This feature is how most **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** players find and connect to servers to play the game. This is *especially* true for those new to the game.
- This list is *heavily curated* to only include select servers that are "known-good" so-to-speak. By default, the behind-the-scenes source for the **HSB** server-list is *only updateable by the game developer directly*. Unfortunately, the developer has been effectively *missing-in-action* for some time.
- Unfortunately, **FoF** currently only includes preview thumbnails for maps that shipped with the game at the time of its last update - nearly **two (2)** years ago. So no preview thumbnails are included for any custom maps released by the community - resulting in the generic **"Custom Map"** icon being shown instead of an actual map preview.
- This update installs map preview thumbnails for a *wide-array of community-generated maps*. Installing this update will replace the generic **Custom Map** with an actual preview thumbnail for most community maps.

Full Server List ("Find Servers"):



- On the initial screen, there is also a **Find Servers** option. This will display a more complete list of current **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** game-servers, but *without any map-preview images*.
- This feature is how many **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** long-term players find and connect to servers to play the game. In particular the **"Favorites"** tab is used extensively by experienced players.
- That list is also entirely un-curated, and may contain servers that are too electronically distant from you to be playable, or are otherwise problematic.
- This update **does not alter the way that "Full" server list works in any way**.
- If you use this feature and like it, please feel free to continue doing-so. I still recommend you apply the update. However, if you rarely use the **HSB** you may see little benefit.

3 - Prerequisites (things you need before updating) Edit

Things you need to **do** or **know** before updating:

- You must already have **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** installed.
- If you have **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** open, close it.
- If you did NOT install **FoF** to the default location, you must know *exactly* where you installed it. The default location (on Windows) is typically:

```
C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\steamapps\common\Fistful of Frags
```

- For example, you might have installed it to a different Steam "Library" on a different hard-drive, resulting in it being installed somewhere such as:

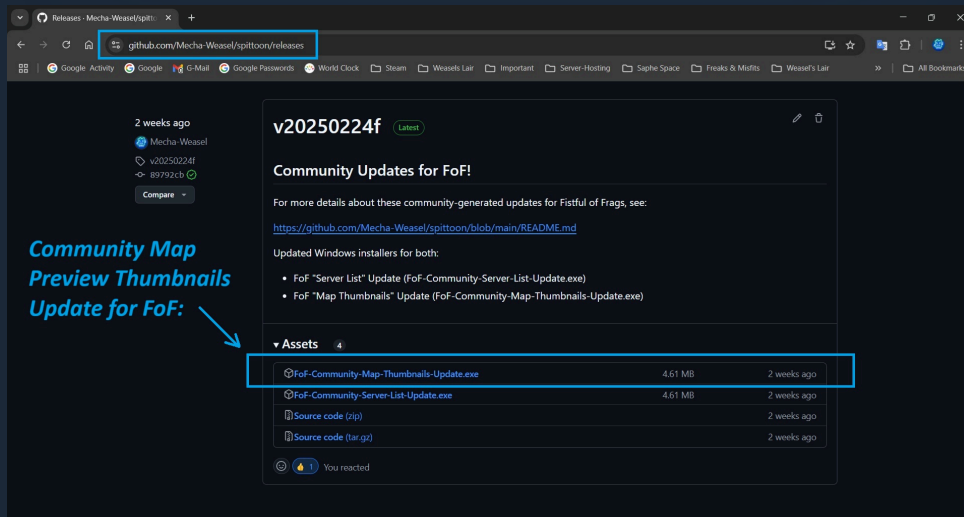
```
D:\SteamLibrary\steamapps\common\Fistful of Frags
```

NOTE: You *may* need to be an "Administrator" on your computer to be able to install software.

4 - Where to get the update? [Edit](#)

The **Windows installation program** for the community **thumbnail update** for **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** is hosted in the "Project Spittoon" **GitHub** [\[github.com\]](https://github.com) . Specifically, the current "release" version is available in the "releases" page [\[github.com\]](https://github.com) .

<https://github.com/Mecha-Weasel/spittoon/releases>



5 - How to install the update (using the installer) [Edit](#)

NOTE: An automated installer program is *only available for Windows*. For **Linux** desktop installations, please see notes further in this guide regarding *manual installation*.

To start the installer program (**FoF-Community-Map-Thumbnails-Update.exe**), just double-click on it - in whatever Windows folder you downloaded it to from your web-browser. Typically, this defaults to your "**Downloads**" folder.

6 - Potential Windows warning [Edit](#)

When to try to start the update installer program, Windows may warn that you are trying to run an "**unrecognized program**" or "**unrecognized app**", as shown below:



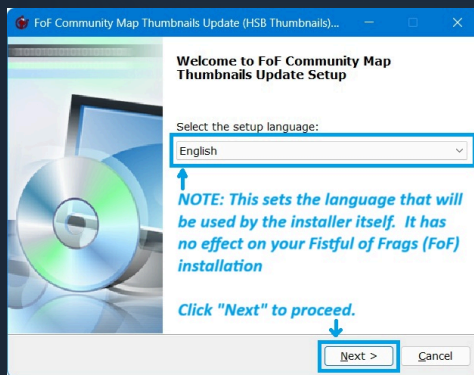
If so, you will need to click the "**More info**" option, to display the "**Run anyway**" button to

proceed, as shown below:

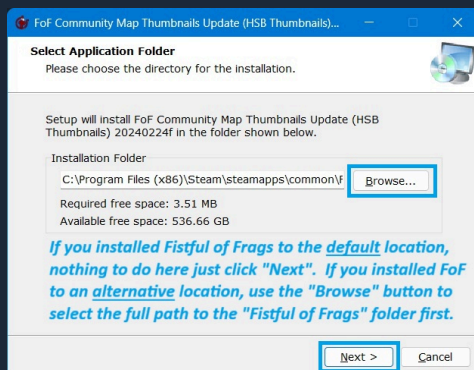


7 - Update installation prompts Edit

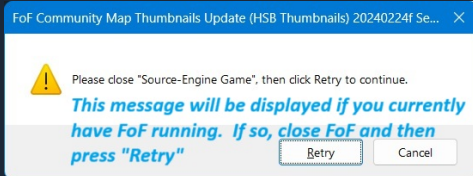
Once you start the installer program, it will prompt you to select a language. This is the language the installer program itself will use, and has no bearing or effect on your existing **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** installation. Select the language you would like, and/or click the **Next** button to continue.



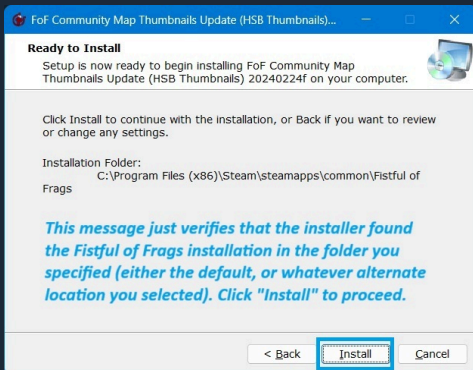
On the next screen, you have to opportunity to select where your existing **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** is located. If you have installed to some alternative location (such as a Steam "Library" setup on a secondary drive), use the **Browse** button to select the "Fistful of Frags" folder. Click **Next** to continue.



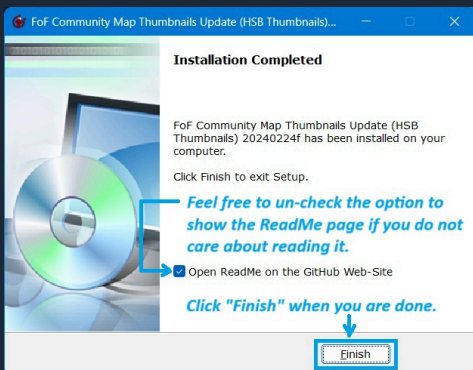
If you forgot to exit **FoF** (or have any other video-game currently running that happens to be based on the same "Source" game-engine) an error will be displayed - giving you an opportunity to switch back to that game and exit it, before continuing with the update installation.



If a valid existing **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** installation is *NOT detected* at the location you select, *an error will be displayed, and the installation of the update will be cancelled*. Otherwise, the next screen shown will display the location where the installer is about to apply the update to. Click **Next** to continue.



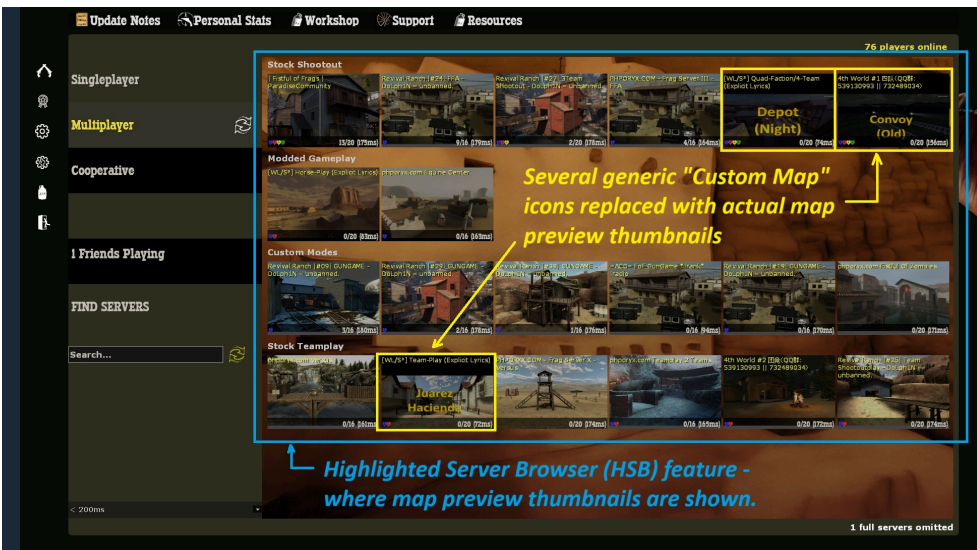
After the update installation completes, a screen will be displayed indicating so. You may click the **Finish** to close the installer.



8 - How to use the update [Edit](#)

Once the update is successfully installed (either using the installer program or manually), just use **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** like normal. The only difference you should see less of the generic **"Custom Map"** icon in the preview thumbnails shown in the **Highlighted Server Browser (HSB)** area of the screen.

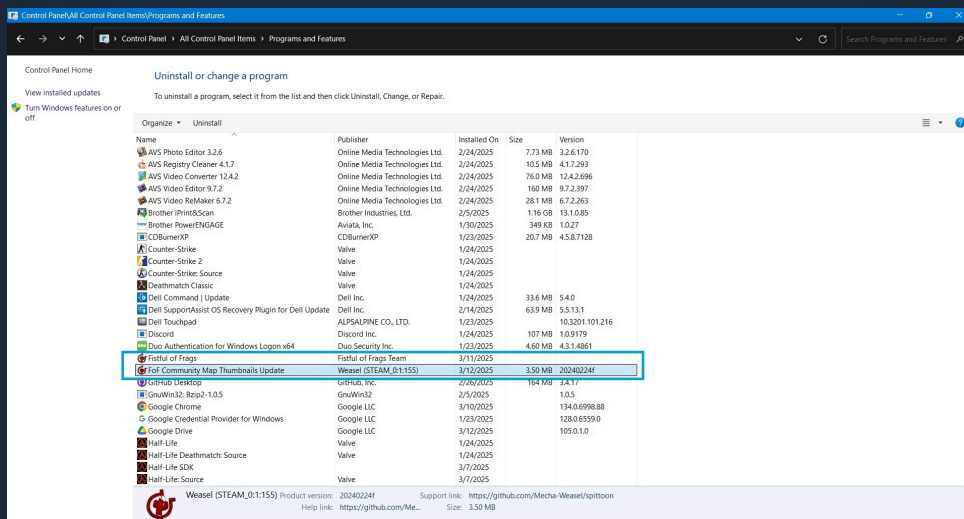
For example, you may notice some map thumbnail previews that previously were not displayed:



Also, you can still play on servers that do not show-up in the **HSB** at all - by *finding them in the "Full" server list*, and right-click on them to add them to your "Favorites" tab.

9 - How to uninstall the update (if installed using the installer) Edit

If you installed this update using the Windows installer program, it should show-up in Windows **Control Panel**, under the **"Programs and Features"** area - *just like any other Windows program.*



<https://github.com/Mecha-Weasel/spittoon/blob/main/FoF-Community-Map-Thumbnail-Update.md#uninstallation-installer>

10 - How to install the update (manually) [Edit](#)

To install this update *manually* (either on **Windows** *without using the installer program*, or on a **Linux** desktop client), please refer to the instructions in the GitHub:

<https://github.com/Mecha-Weasel/spittoon/blob/main/FoF-Community-Map-Thumbnail-Update.md#installation-manual>

11 - How to uninstall the update (manually) Edit

If you installed the update *manually* (either on **Windows** *without using the installer program*, or on a **Linux** desktop client), please refer to the instructions in the GitHub:

```
https://github.com/Mecha-Weasel/spittoon/blob/main/FoF-Community-Map-Thumbnails-Update.md#uninstallation-manual
```

12 - Who created this update? Edit

This update was created by **Weasel**, with the *a lot of assistance* from various server operators and/or active players that among the broader **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** community, including (but not necessarily limited to):

- **Weasel** (as mentioned above) = A long-time community server operator for **FoF** (and other games, dating back to 1999).
- **Judge** = A long-time **FoF** community advocate / community organizer, active player and some-time server operator.
- **Paralhama** = A long-time active **FoF** player, server operator, and community map contributor.
- **Wolfgang** = A long-time active **FoF** player.

Speaking of the broader **Fistful of Frags (FoF)** community, *numerous additional players* from several Discord-based communities have participated in testing this update, including:

- The "**Saloon**" (a long-established FoF-supportive community)
- The "**Salty Spitoon Saloon**" (a recently-established community for active FoF advancement).

13 - Additional Information Edit

Links to various additional information are included below:

- The "Project Spitoon" GitHub [github.com]
- Information about "Project Spitoon" [github.com]
- Information about this **HSB thumbnail previews update** [github.com]
- Information about the (related) **HSB server list update** [github.com]
- Frequently-Asked-Questions (FAQ) [github.com]

FYI: Anyone is welcome to plagiarize this guide as desired, to make alternative versions in different languages, or fulfill other needs.



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